PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft 365 Security, Incident Response and Vulnerability Management Specialist

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience protecting enterprise systems, data and users across Microsoft 365, cloud platforms and network infrastructure. I bring deep hands-on expertise in Microsoft Defender (Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, Defender for Cloud Apps), Microsoft Intune, Microsoft Purview and Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), including the design and enforcement of Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and privileged identity controls. I lead end-to-end incident response operations aligned to the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) 800-61 framework and conduct proactive threat hunting using the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I have extensive experience in vulnerability management, security reviews and CIS Controls and Cyber Essentials Plus compliance, and I am committed to building resilient security postures that protect organisations and the people they serve.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft 365 Security:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Cloud Apps, Microsoft Purview, Microsoft Sentinel
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Identity Management (PIM), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Endpoint and Device Management:** Microsoft Intune (Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM)), CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Tanium
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle, MITRE ATT&CK framework, digital forensics, containment and eradication, post-incident review
- **Threat Hunting and Detection:** CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Discover, Microsoft Sentinel KQL queries, Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), threat intelligence integration
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; risk prioritisation and remediation tracking
- **Network and Perimeter Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall, Mimecast email security, network security monitoring
- **Frameworks and Compliance:** CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), ISO 27001, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure, hybrid cloud environments, cloud security architecture and posture management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Protect systems, data and users across a Microsoft 365 environment of over 8,000 users, managing security controls across Microsoft Defender, Intune, Entra ID and Purview.
- Lead incident response operations following NIST 800-61 procedures, managing the full lifecycle from initial detection and triage through containment, eradication and post-incident review.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel KQL queries, applying MITRE ATT&CK techniques to identify adversarial activity before automated detections trigger.
- Manage vulnerability management operations using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io and AppCheck, prioritising findings by risk and tracking remediation to closure.

- Design and enforce Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access policies and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) configurations, reducing identity-based attack surface across cloud and hybrid environments.
- Oversee Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies, ensuring endpoint compliance and secure device access.
- Administer Microsoft Purview data loss prevention and information protection controls, protecting sensitive organisational data.
- Lead internal security reviews and support penetration testing activities, translating findings into actionable remediation plans aligned to CIS Controls and Cyber Essentials Plus requirements.
- Develop and maintain SOAR playbooks using PowerShell and Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps, automating alert triage and response workflows.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Operated as a core member of the security operations team, protecting a hybrid Microsoft 365 and Azure infrastructure serving over 8,000 students, staff and stakeholders.
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) identity security controls including Conditional Access, privileged identity management and Single Sign-On (SSO) integrations, hardening the identity perimeter across cloud and on-premises systems.
- Supported deployment and configuration of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across the full endpoint estate, achieving comprehensive coverage and enforcing security baselines.
- Performed vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and AppCheck, producing risk-prioritised reports and working with teams across the organisation to drive timely remediation.
- Supported Check Point Harmony firewall policy management and Mimecast email security configuration, reducing threat vectors at the network perimeter and email gateway.
- Contributed to Cyber Essentials Plus certification activities, verifying technical controls met UK Government requirements and supporting the evidence collection and assessment process.
- Responded to security incidents and alerts escalated from first-line monitoring, applying structured incident response procedures to contain and resolve threats.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech)

- Delivered security engineering support across SaaS platform and infrastructure environments, covering network security, endpoint protection and identity and access management.
- Implemented security tooling for vulnerability management, endpoint protection and access control, supporting ISO 27001 compliance activities and internal audit readiness.
- Responded to security incidents and anomalous activity, coordinating with infrastructure and development teams to investigate, contain and remediate threats.
- Supported cloud migration and IT infrastructure improvement projects, applying security-by-design principles throughout delivery.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Microsoft Defender for Identity across an 8,000-user hybrid Microsoft 365 environment, delivering comprehensive endpoint and identity threat detection and response coverage.
- Designed and implemented a comprehensive Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access framework, reducing unauthorised access risk and enforcing least-privilege access across cloud and hybrid systems.
- Established a vulnerability management programme using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) and Tenable.io, reducing the organisation's critical and high-severity vulnerability backlog by systematically tracking and driving remediation.
- Built and maintained a threat hunting capability using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel, proactively identifying and neutralising threats that bypassed automated detections.
- Supported UAL's achievement and renewal of Cyber Essentials Plus certification, ensuring all required technical controls were in place and evidenced.

- Automated security operations workflows using PowerShell and Microsoft Sentinel SOAR playbooks, improving analyst efficiency and reducing response times for common incident types.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)